understand how wealth creation works. Who’s benefiting from our silence? Not us.

I love referring back to a panel that included Sallie Krawcheck, where they discussed the fact that in our culture 61 per cent of women would rather speak about their death than their money (according to the 2018 Age Wave and Merrill Lynch report, ‘Women & Financial Wellness: Beyond the Bottom Line’). A woman in the audience disputed that claim. In response, Krawcheck asked her: ‘Cremated or burial?’

‘Cremated.’

Krawcheck then asked, ‘What was your income in the last year?’

Silence.

When we create a narrative saying ‘speaking about money is wrong’ or ‘wanting money is wrong’, we prevent thousands of people who didn’t grow up with financially savvy parents, teachers or relatives from accessing financial literacy. While I agree with the sentiment that schools should make financial literacy compulsory, teachers are already up to their necks in planning, organising and transmitting information in highly underfunded circumstances. Conversations about money shouldn’t solely be the burden of the schooling system.

Instead, we should be encouraging conversations about money in our own circles and communities; there are so many benefits to speaking up. Knowing what your colleagues make can be used to make sure you’re not falling victim to the wage gap. Knowing what your seniors or mentors make opens up the doors to understanding what the current ceiling looks like. Speaking about the process of buying a home, what a mortgage entails, the benefits of credit cards and even what the stock market is, aren’t necessarily conversations you’d have over coffee with your relatives or even your best friends, yet they are crucial to breaking down these barriers of financial literacy.

Everything is unknown until we talk about it, and the only way to understand it is to open up the dialogue about money.